

APAC Technology

Glass in advanced packaging: Limited near-term upside for Taiwan display makers

Equities

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Technology

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Limited contribution in the next several years

We summarize our recent supply chain checks on the potential roles of Taiwan display panel makers in advanced packaging. Among the key opportunities under discussion – glass carriers, glass interposers and glass-core substrates – supply chain feedback suggests display panel makers are less likely to supply glass carriers for CoPoS (chip-on-panel-on substrate) applications, while higher technical barriers and a less compelling cost structure for glass interposers limit panel makers' participation in the segment. Among the three opportunities, glass-core substrates appear to offer the most viable entry point for panel makers, supported by a relatively better aligned business model and manufacturing expertise. However, several challenges remain, including process complexity, warpage issues from thermal expansion mismatches, reliability concerns as sizes get bigger and competition from alternative substrate materials, which could constrain adoption and commercialization. As a result, awhile UBS projects the [advanced packaging TAM](#) to expand from US\$19bn in 2026 to US\$122bn by 2030, implying a 59% CAGR, we expect the revenue contribution from advanced packaging to remain limited for Taiwan display panel makers in the next several years, rather than a meaningful growth driver.

CoWoS/CoPoS carriers: Glass is not the only solution

Over the past several years, we believe glass has been adopted as the mainstream carrier material used for temporary physical and mechanical support carriers during TSMC's CoWoS (chip-on-wafer-on substrate) process. We believe its glass carriers are primarily supplied by glass makers such as Corning, AGC, NEG and Schott, among others. According to our recent supply chain checks, the industry is evaluating ceramic as the next-generation carrier material. Compared with glass, ceramic has a similar CTE (coefficient of thermal expansion) as matched to silicon, while providing a significantly higher Young's modulus, approximately 4-5x that of glass and silicon. As a result, ceramic is better positioned to suppress warpage during the CoWoS process, particularly as the RDL layer counts keep increasing and package complexity rises. In the FOPLP ecosystem, multiple carrier materials have been adopted, including glass, organic and alloy steel across IDM, foundry and OSAT makers with panel sizes ranging from 300x300mm to 700x700mm. For TSMC's forthcoming CoPoS platform, we believe initial production is likely to utilize a 310x310mm glass panel carrier, although migration toward ceramic remains possible over time. Also, regarding the recent [media reports](#) about the the supply of 310x310mm silicon panels for CoPoS, we think it could be for test monitoring wafers, rather than production panel carriers. Since glass panels are primarily used as temporary mechanical support through subsequent processes, and given the dominance of established glass material suppliers, we foresee a limited opportunity for Taiwan display panel makers such as AUO and Innolux to supply glass carriers, given a lack of differentiation and processing value add.

Glass interposers: Near-term adoption appears unlikely

Among TSMC's three major CoWoS architectures (CoWoS-L, CoWoS-R and CoWoS-S), only CoWoS-S adopts a silicon interposer during the process. Based on our recent supply chain checks, we believe foundries are unlikely to retain the interposer architectures as they transition toward CoPoS, given its relatively higher cost structure and increasing focus on shifting to other approaches, such as RDL (redistribution layer) and local silicon interconnect. Nevertheless, we believe the industry continues to evaluate panel-level interposer technology, with glass and ceramic as potential candidate materials. For Taiwan display panel makers, participation in the glass interposer opportunity is likely to be constrained by significant technological barriers. Current panel manufacturing processes typically support line widths of ~5um compared with the sub-micron capability enabled by foundry process nodes. As a result, even if glass interposers eventually gain broader adoption, the substantial gap in current manufacturing precision could limit the ability of display panel makers to capture a meaningful share of the value chain.

Glass-core substrates: Better opportunities for display panel makers but still a lot of challenges

Glass-core substrate technology is not new, as it has been explored since the 1990s, although mass adoption historically has been limited due to unfavorable economics and yield-related challenges. Interest in the technology has recently resurfaced as AI accelerators and advanced processors continue to push reticle sizes and package dimensions beyond the limits of existing substrate technologies. At a recent JPCA (Japan Electronics Packaging and Circuits Association) exhibition, TSMC disclosed that it is collaborating with Ibiden and Innolux on glass-core substrate development, underscoring growing industry interest in the technology for future AI GPU/ASICs applications as reticle sizes further increase. That said, we believe substantial development and qualification work remains before large-scale commercialization can occur. Among the potential advanced packaging opportunities discussed for display panel makers, we view glass-core substrates as the most likely path. Specifically, panel makers could leverage their expertise in glass processing and handling to supply TGV (through-glass via) panels to ABF (Ajinomoto build-up film) substrate manufacturers for subsequent glass-core substrate fabrication. Beyond Taiwan display panel makers, broader ecosystem participants include Corning, AGC, DNP, Toppan, TPK, BOE, Lens Tech, and among others.

Despite increasing industry engagement, our supply chain research indicates several key technical challenges remain unresolved. First, high-aspect-ratio TGV formation continues to require further improvement in laser drilling and inspection capability. Second, the metallization process following TGV formation remains under development, with the industry evaluating multiple approaches, including copper plating, copper pillars and copper paste-based solutions. Third, preventing microcrack formation during manufacturing and ensuring long-term reliability remain critical hurdles that could delay mass-production timelines. In addition, thermal-mechanical reliability remains a key concern. Glass-core substrates can experience warpage and stress resulting from CTE mismatches with surrounding materials, as well as local stress during the TGV and copper metallization process, particularly as package sizes continue to increase. To address these challenges, the supply chain is evaluating alternative core materials, including ceramic/aluminum nitride (AlN) and silicon carbide (SiC), which may offer superior thermal and mechanical properties. Based on our industry discussions, some experts believe ceramic-core substrates may ultimately prove more commercially viable than glass-core substrates due to their better CTE characteristics and improved resistance to warpage.

Stocks: We prefer Chroma over display panel makers

Among our coverage, we view **Chroma** as the clearest beneficiary of the ongoing expansion in advanced packaging capacity, particularly at TSMC and leading OSATs. Chroma's metrology solutions (~10% of sales in 2027E) have been adopted by TSMC for precise measurement of complex advanced-packaging (ie, CoWoS) structures such as TSV/VIA, RDL, probe marks, overlay and surface roughness. It has also been working with its customer on a metrology tool for CoPoS (310x310mm substrate size) and received an order from its customer in H126. In contrast, we remain more cautious on Taiwan display panel makers. For **Innolux**, we acknowledge its efforts in diversifying beyond traditional display applications through investment in FOPLP and glass-related applications. However, based on our industry research, we believe the revenue contribution from these emerging businesses is likely to remain limited in the next

several years, while its valuation is stretched, at 1.75x 2027E P/BV with ~1.7% ROE. For **AUO**, we believe its focus has shifted toward automotive, microLED display, glass antennas and CPO. Although we think its automotive business is on track to enjoy a double-digit CAGR on new customer project wins, we believe the revenue contribution from advanced packaging, microLED and CPO is unlikely to be meaningful in the next several years.

Figure 1: Comparison of material characteristics for CoWoS/CoPoS

Material	CTE (ppm/°C)	Young's Modulus (GPa)
Silicon	~2.6	120–190
Glass (for advanced packaging)	~3.0–9.0	70–85
Ceramic (Aluminium Nitride)	~4.0–5.5	300–400
Silicon Carbide	~3.8-4.1	380-450

Source: UBS

Figure 2: Potential suppliers for glass panel carriers and glass TGV

	Suppliers	Alternative materials
Glass panel carriers	Glass: Corning, AGC, NEG, Schott, etc	Ceramic
Glass-core substrates	TGV: Innolux, Corning, AGC, DNP, Toppan, TPK, BOE, Lens Tech, Unimicron, etc	Ceramic, Silicon Carbide

Source: UBS

Valuation Method and Risk Statement

Valuation methodologies in the sector include target price-to-book multiples based on long-term average ROE and COE.

Investing in the technology sector involves a high degree of risk. Rapid technological changes, increasing competition and exposure to macroeconomic cycles are among the many risks faced by investors in technology stocks. Moreover, it is extremely difficult to project the financial results of tech companies, since their operating models are highly volatile and unpredictable. Finally, valuing technology stocks can prove challenging, as neither traditional nor non-traditional valuation measures have provided much insight into how these stocks trade.

AUO Corp:

We derive our price target based on target P/BV relative to AUO's historical trading range.

We believe AUO faces several risks, including industry cyclicality, volatile demand, rapid technology migration, intense competition and high capex. Since the TFT-LCD business is highly geared, any changes in panel prices could significantly affect AUO's bottom line. AUO also faces potential component shortages that could impact the industry's supply-demand outlook, as well as panel prices.

Chroma ATE:

We value Chroma ATE using a PE methodology.

Downside risks include weaker-than-expected demand for high-performance computing dampening its semiconductor testing business and slower-than-expected recovery in EV investments into battery capacity installations.

INNOLUX Corporation:

Our price target is derived from target P/BV methodology and is relative to Innolux's historical trading range. We believe Innolux faces several risks, including uncertain end-demand, industry competition, panel S/D imbalance and new technologies.

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Neutral	FSR is between -6% and 6% of the MRA.	40%	21%
Sell	FSR is > 6% below the MRA.	6%	21%

Source: UBS. Rating allocations are as of 30 June 2026.

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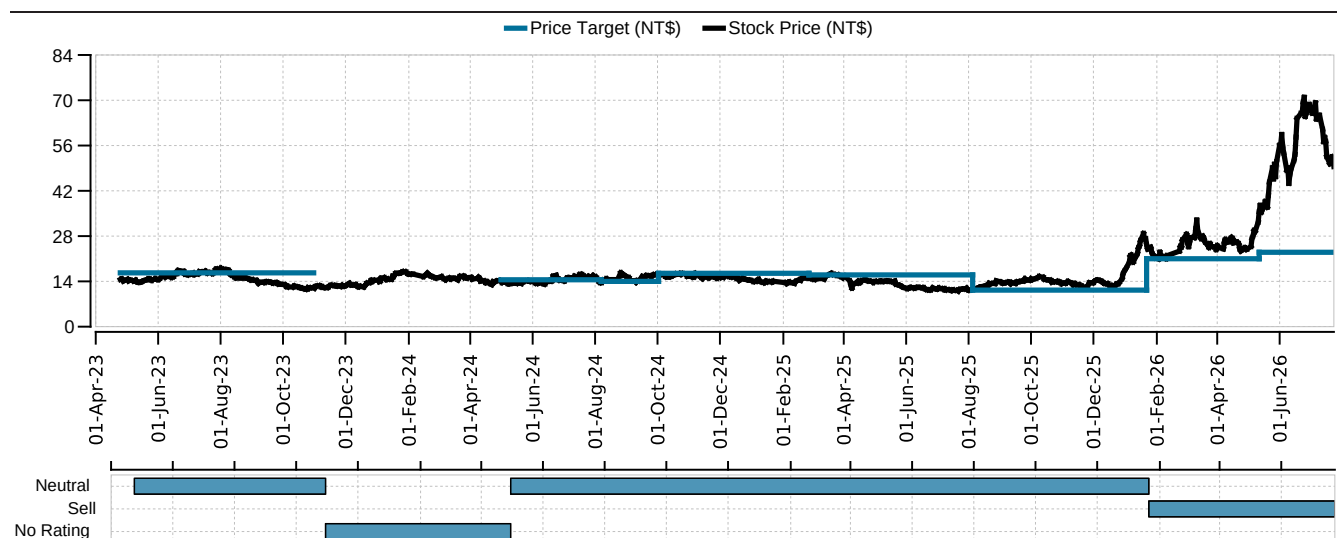
Company Name	Reuters	12-month rating	Price	Price date
AUO Corp ¹⁸	2409.TW	Neutral	NT\$25.50	24 Jul 2026
Chroma ATE ²⁸	2360.TW	Buy	NT\$2,080	24 Jul 2026
INNOLUX Corporation ^{1,5,6,28}	3481.TW	Sell	NT\$49.50	24 Jul 2026

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon. All prices as of local market close. Ratings in this table are the most current published ratings prior to this report. They may be more recent than the stock pricing date.

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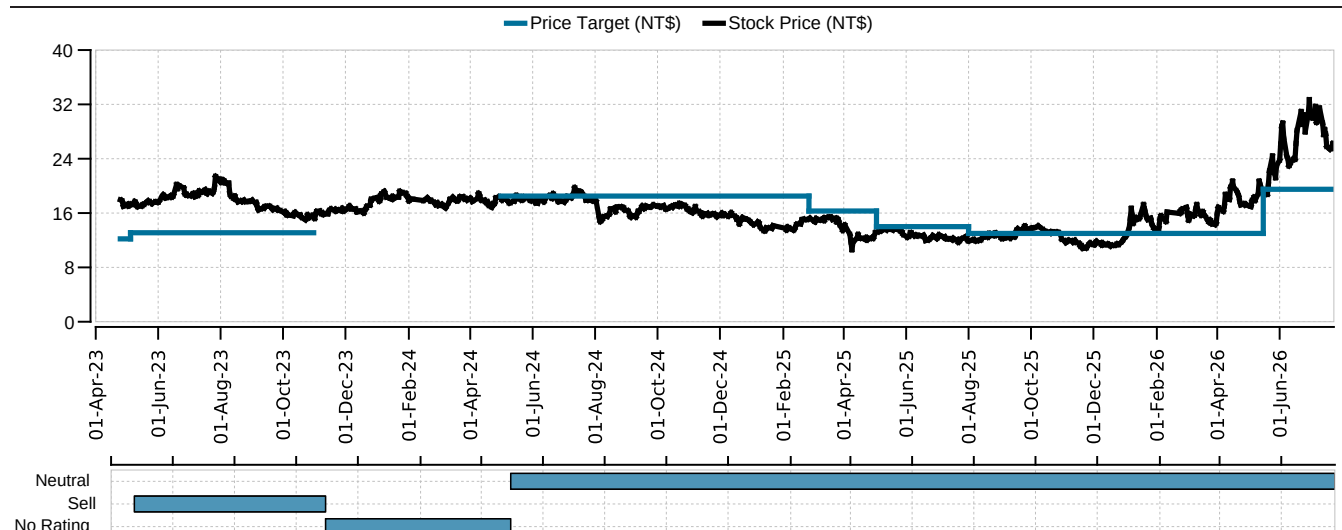
INNOLUX Corporation (NT\$)



Date	Stock Price (NT\$)	Price Target (NT\$)	Rating
2023-04-24	14.95	16.637	Neutral
2023-10-30	12.05	-	No Rating
2024-04-30	14.25	14.50	Neutral
2024-08-06	13.65	14.00	Neutral
2024-10-01	16.00	16.50	Neutral
2025-02-25	15.05	16.00	Neutral
2025-08-04	11.45	11.30	Neutral
2026-01-21	27.15	21.00	Sell
2026-05-11	32.30	23.00	Sell

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 24-Jul-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

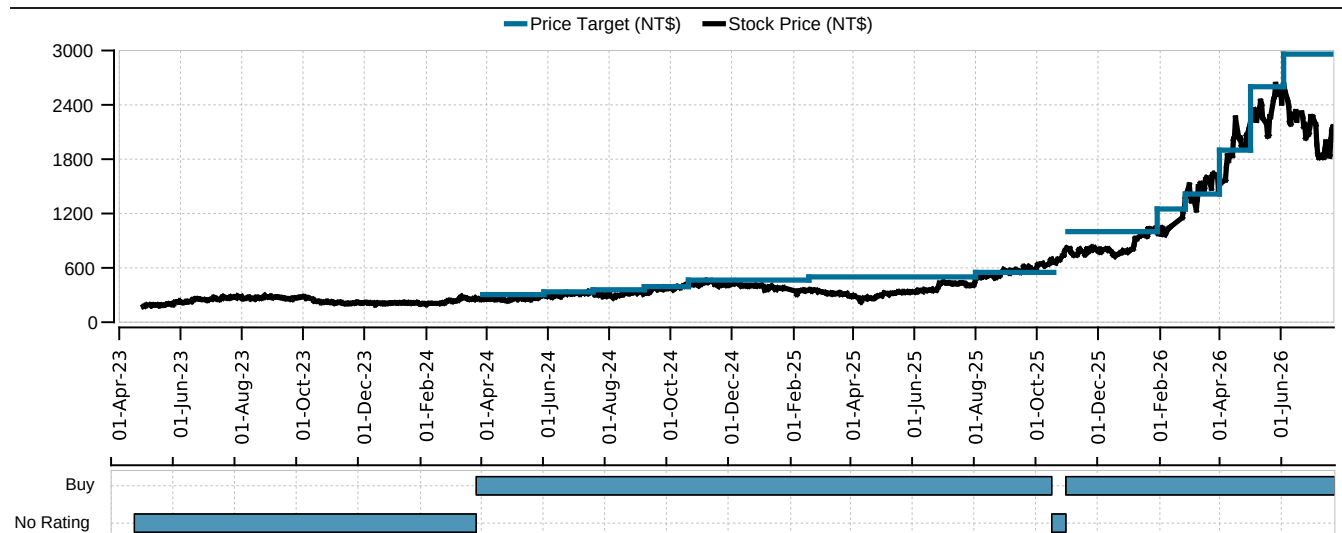
AUO Corp (NT\$)



Date	Stock Price (NT\$)	Price Target (NT\$)	Rating
2023-04-24	18.35	12.20	Sell
2023-05-04	17.10	13.10	Sell
2023-10-30	15.65	-	No Rating
2024-04-30	18.30	18.50	Neutral
2025-02-25	15.10	16.30	Neutral
2025-05-02	13.15	14.00	Neutral
2025-07-31	12.00	13.00	Neutral
2026-05-15	19.05	19.50	Neutral

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 24-Jul-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

Chroma ATE (NT\$)



Date	Stock Price (NT\$)	Price Target (NT\$)	Rating
2023-04-24	176.50	-	No Rating
2024-03-27	256.00	305.00	Buy
2024-05-27	293.50	335.00	Buy
2024-07-15	335.00	358.00	Buy
2024-09-04	311.00	393.00	Buy
2024-10-18	416.00	465.00	Buy
2025-02-15	350.00	500.00	Buy
2025-07-31	430.50	550.00	Buy

Date	Stock Price (NT\$)	Price Target (NT\$)	Rating
2025-10-17	662.00	-	No Rating
2025-10-31	819.00	1000.00	Buy
2026-01-28	1035.00	1250.00	Buy
2026-02-25	1255.00	1415.00	Buy
2026-03-31	1465.00	1900.00	Buy
2026-05-01	2120.00	2600.00	Buy
2026-06-03	2545.00	2960.00	Buy

Source: UBS Global Research; LSEG Eikon as of 24-Jul-2026. All prices as of local market close. Ratings as of date shown.

Additional Prices: TPK Holding, NT\$62.7 (24 Jul 2026); Lens Technology, Rmb37.32 (24 Jul 2026); Ibiden, ¥17370 (24 Jul 2026); Taiwan Semiconductor Manufacturing, NT\$2350.00 (24 Jul 2026); Toppan Printing, ¥4852 (24 Jul 2026); AGC, ¥6187 (24 Jul 2026); Nippon Electric Glass, ¥5517 (24 Jul 2026); Dai Nippon Printing, ¥3139 (24 Jul 2026); BOE Technology Group, Rmb5.79 (24 Jul 2026); Corning Inc, US\$156.06 (23 Jul 2026); Source: UBS. All prices as of local market close.

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